ATHLETIC DEVELOPMENT CLUB

STUDIO VA

LONDON, UNITED KINGDOM

CURATED BY PAULA PINTOS

COFFEE SHOP, GYMNASIUM

#ASSIGNMENT 24

BY: PRIYANSHI MATHUR

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INTRODUCTION

In this project, They designed Athletic Development Club / Studio VA as a multifunctional environment that combines an athletic training studio with a coffee bar and curated retail space.
The intention was to move beyond the traditional idea of a gym and instead create a lifestyle-oriented athletic hub. The space is designed not only for physical training but also for social interaction, recovery, and brand engagement.
The coffee shop and retail sections are not treated as secondary add-ons; instead, they are strategically integrated into the spatial planning to enhance user experience and commercial value.

ARCHITECTS: STUDIO VA

AREA: 180 M^2

YEAR: 2021

PHOTOGRAPHS:NICK SMITH

LEAD ARCHITECTS: AKIS PATTIHIS

DESIGN PHILOSOPHY & CONCEPT

The core concept of this project is based on the idea of “Performance Meets Community.”
Athletic environments are often intense and function-driven, while cafés are relaxed and socially engaging. My design merges these contrasting atmospheres into a cohesive spatial language.
They used strong linear elements, exposed textures, and industrial materials to reflect energy and strength, while warmer lighting and wood textures soften the environment in the coffee zone.
The overall design expresses movement, rhythm, and structure — qualities that represent athletic performance.

The space combines:
Physical training
Social relaxation (coffee zone)
Athletic lifestyle retail

The design language reflects:
Strength
Movement
Industrial-modern aesthetics
Raw yet refined materials

PROJECT OVERVIEW

WHY ADD RETAIL & COFFEE IN AN ATHLETIC CLUB?

Studio VA did not want the building to function only as a training center.
They introduced:

- Sports retail
- Coffee shop / café

Smart Planning Strategy:

Retail and coffee shop are placed:
Near the entrance In public-facing zone With direct access from outside Separated from private training areas

This allows:

Visitors to access café without entering training zone Spectators to relax while athletes train Controlled circulation

COFFEE SPACE - ATHLETIC DEVELOPMENT CLUB / STUDIO VA

The coffee space in the Athletic Development Club functions as a social anchor and transitional zone between high-performance training areas and public engagement spaces. Rather than being treated as a secondary add-on, it is designed as an integral architectural component that enhances user experience, community interaction, and brand identity.

The café acts as a recovery and interaction zone within the athletic environment. After intense physical training, users psychologically and physically transition into a calmer setting. The coffee space supports this shift by offering:

Architecturally and functionally, the coffee space:
Extends user duration within the facility
Encourages community building
Enhances commercial viability
Strengthens brand presence
It becomes a transition space between athletic performance and everyday life.

2D
TECHNICAL DRAWINGS

2D TECHNICAL DRAWING

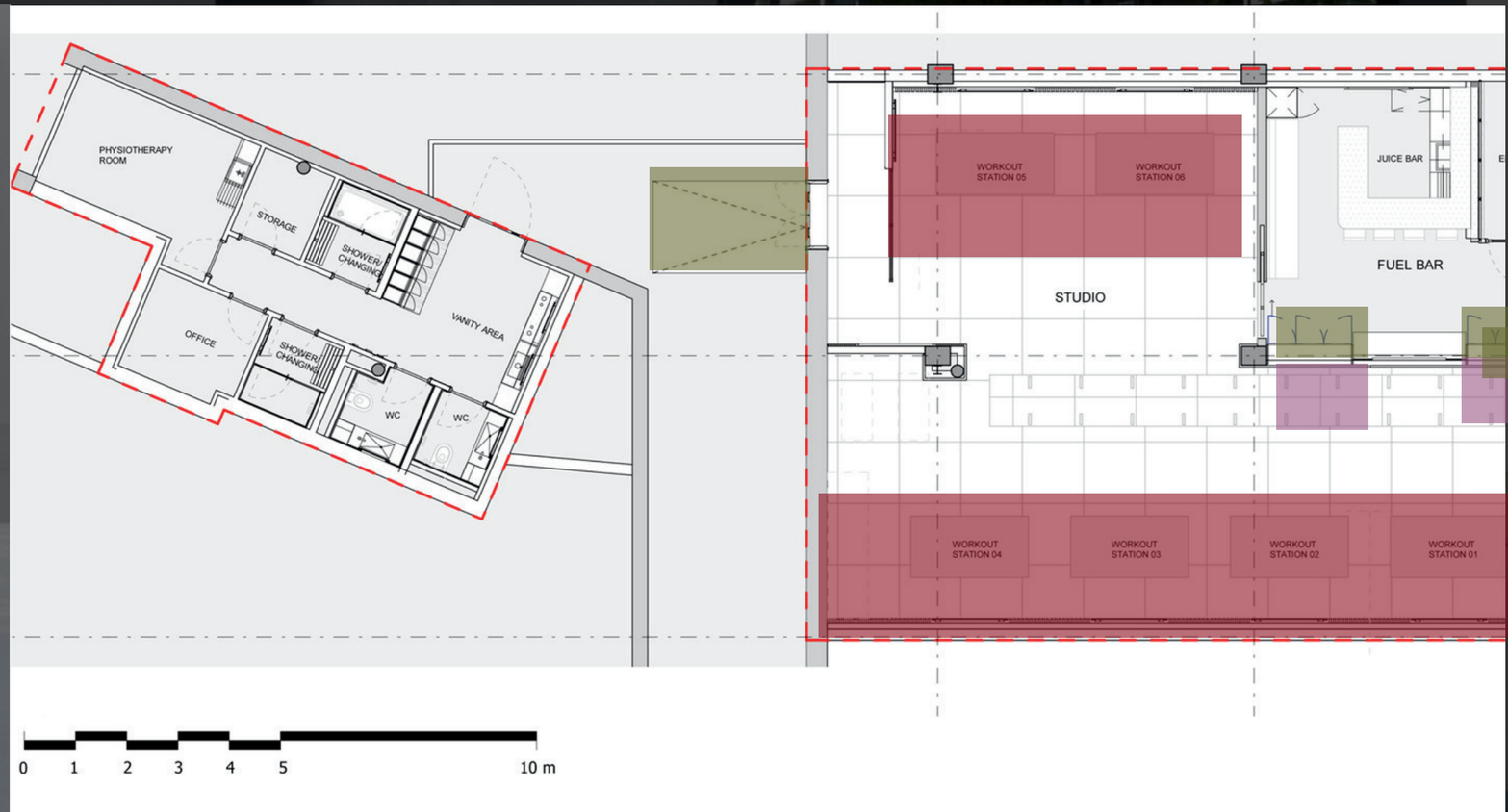
FLOOR PLAN EXPLANATION

In the 2D technical floor plan, It represents accurate spatial dimensions, wall thicknesses, furniture layouts, and circulation clearances.
The entrance door placement is aligned to provide direct visual access to the reception and coffee counter. The reception desk is designed with ergonomic dimensions and positioned to monitor both entry and studio access.
The coffee counter is designed at a standard height of approximately 900 mm. Behind the counter, They allocated space for equipment placement, under-counter storage, refrigeration, and preparation surfaces. The workflow follows a logical sequence from storage to preparation to service, ensuring operational efficiency.

- The retail area consists of wall-mounted shelving units with a depth suitable for apparel and accessories display. Freestanding units are positioned carefully to maintain a minimum circulation clearance of approximately 1200 mm along primary pathways. This ensures accessibility and comfort.

- The training studio area is planned as an open flexible zone with adequate spacing between equipment to maintain safety standards. Rubber flooring and clear zoning allow for functional versatility.

- All doors are shown with proper swing directions, and sectional markers indicate vertical references for further detailing in elevations.



2D TECHNICAL DRAWING

ELEVATION

This elevation provides a wide-angle, architectural look at the integrated facility, combining the gym area with the retail/fuel bar section. It's essentially a "flattened" view that shows how the different zones transition into one another.

The feature wall elevation within the training area incorporates the Athletic Development Club / Studio VA branding. The scale and positioning of the logo are proportioned according to viewing angles from the entrance.

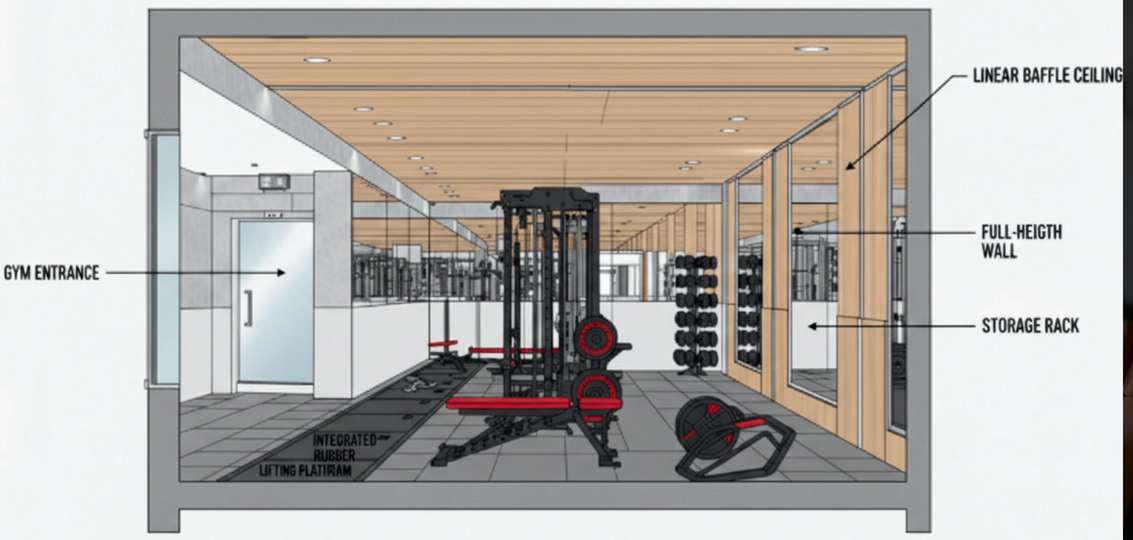
The retail wall elevation demonstrates a modular metal framework system with adjustable shelving. Integrated LED strip lighting is embedded beneath shelves to highlight products and create depth.

The coffee counter elevation shows the front cladding treatment, counter thickness, and branding placement. Overhead, I designed a suspended menu board integrated with focused lighting to enhance visual emphasis.

2D TECHNICAL DRAWING

SECTIONS

ARCHITECTURAL SECTION DIAGRAM: COMPACT FITNESS CENTRE



This facility is a modern, integrated fitness and wellness center that combines high-performance training with recovery and retail services. The space is divided into several specialized zones:

- Main Studio: A large workout area containing multiple numbered stations, cable machines, and a functional training track.
- Fuel Bar: A dedicated retail and social hub located near the entrance, featuring a service counter, "Juice Bar," and merchandise displays.
- Wellness Wing: A separate section of the floor plan dedicated to administrative and recovery services, including a physiotherapy room, private offices, and full changing/WC facilities.
- Design Aesthetic: The interior features a sophisticated industrial look characterized by dark tones, linear wood-slat ceilings, mirrored walls, and vibrant neon or LED accent lighting.

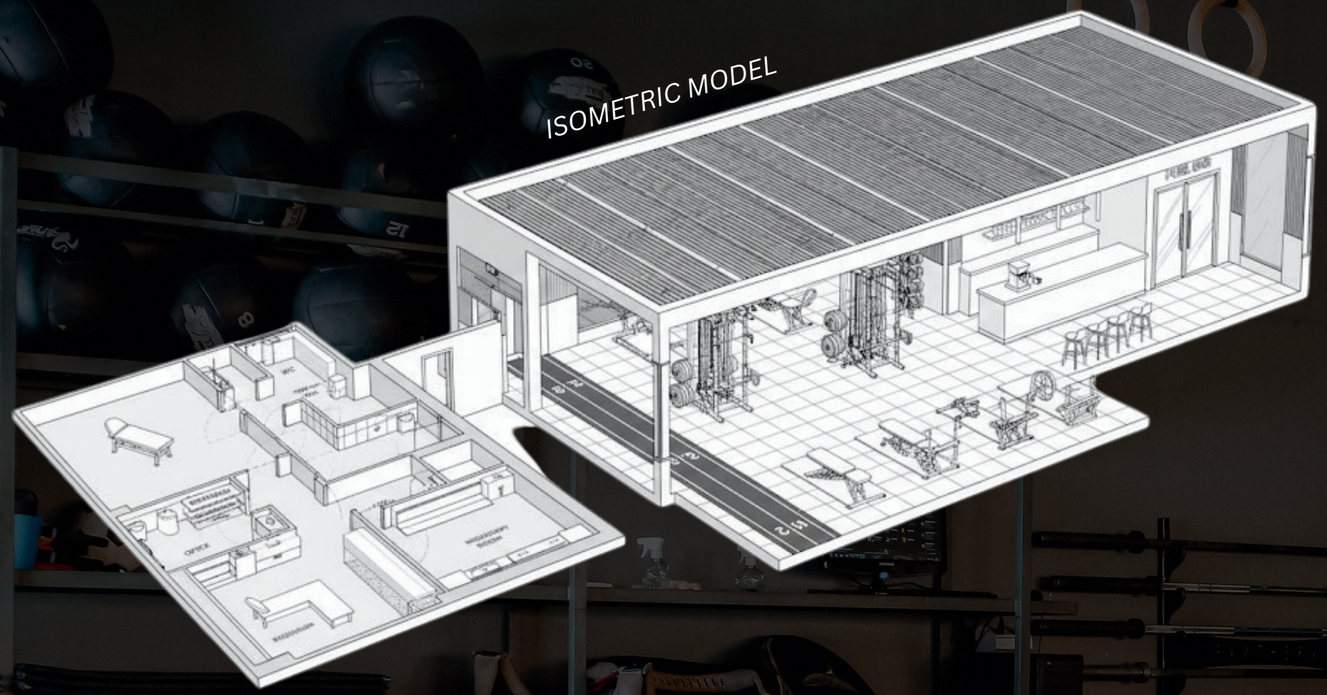
This integrated facility is a high-end wellness and performance center that blends professional athletic training with recovery and retail.

- Primary Zones: The floor plan is anchored by a large Studio featuring six numbered workout stations and a functional track, supported by a specialized Physiotherapy Room and private office.
- Retail & Social: A dedicated Fuel Bar near the entrance includes a "Juice Bar" and a retail area displaying branded merchandise like hoodies and hats.
- Design Aesthetic: The space utilizes a sophisticated, moody palette with industrial materials, linear slatted ceilings for acoustics, and hanging greenery to soften the retail zone.
- Amenities: The facility includes comprehensive utility spaces such as a dedicated vanity area, multiple shower/changing rooms, and separate WC facilities.

ARCHITECTURAL SECTION DIAGRAM: RETAIL AND CAFE INTERIOR

ISOMETRIC VIEW

This isometric view provides a 3D structural breakdown of the entire facility, illustrating how the two primary building blocks—the recovery wing and the main fitness hub—connect via a central corridor.



ISOMETRIC MODEL

Functional Layout

- The Main Studio (Right): This high-ceilinged volume houses the core workout area, featuring numbered functional stations and a dedicated sprint track.
- The Fuel Bar & Retail (Far Right): Integrated into the front of the studio, this zone includes the juice bar counter, stools, and the main entrance.
- The Wellness & Admin Wing (Left): This lower-profile section is separated for privacy, containing the physiotherapy room, private office, and extensive changing facilities.

Structural Components

- Ceiling Systems: The drawing highlights the industrial slatted ceiling in the gym area, which contrasts with the more traditional enclosed rooms in the wellness wing.
- Circulation: The central door and hallway serve as the "bridge" between the loud, high-energy environment of the gym and the quiet, clinical environment of the physiotherapy area.
- Spatial Volume: By removing the "roof" in this view, you can see the varying heights of the interior walls and how the equipment is distributed to maintain clear pathways for athletes.

RENDERED ISOMETRIC VIEW

ISOMETRIC VIEW

Outdoor Area

1.Spatial Relationship

The Main Terrace: The large, rectangular gray volume represents the primary outdoor area. The isometric angle shows how this platform is elevated or distinct from the service core below.

The Service Core: You can see the internal layout of the "Changing Rooms Below" (labeled), including the WC (water closet) units and shower areas. This view shows how the smaller, functional rooms are tightly packed to maximize the open terrace space above.

2. Functional Details

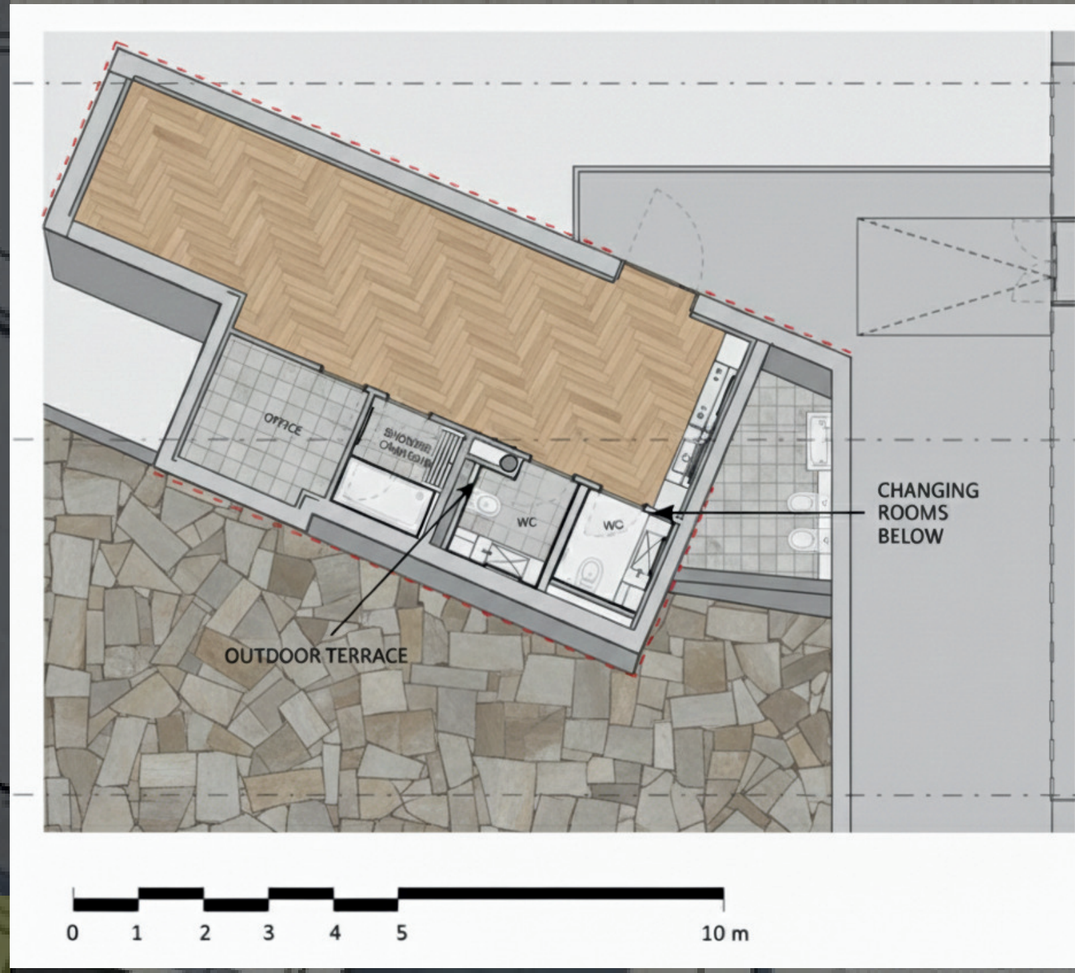
Office & Utilities: The labels identify an office space and wet areas (WC/Showers). The lines indicate plumbing fixtures and cabinetry, showing the high density of utility in this section of the building.

Thresholds: You can see the door swings and entry points, illustrating how users transition from the enclosed service areas to the open-air terrace.

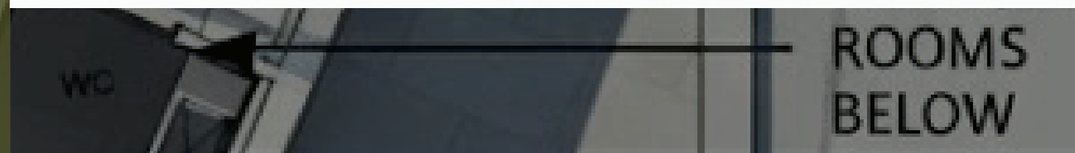
3. Scale and Dimension

Graphic Scale: The bar at the bottom (0 to 10 meters) remains accurate in this view. It helps you visualize the actual size of the space—for example, the main terrace area is roughly $10\text{m} \times 4\text{m}$, providing a significant footprint for outdoor activities.

Dashed Red Line: This "property line" or "extent of work" boundary shows the footprint of the structure within the larger site context.



This view is particularly useful for understanding vertical stacking. It confirms that the heavy infrastructure (bathrooms and offices) is clustered together to provide a clean, unobstructed "outdoor spatial area" for the users.



This layout follows a "Retail-to-Wellness" logic: the "Fuel Bar" acts as an inviting storefront, while the workout stations are tucked further back to provide privacy for members while they train.

ISOMETRIC VIEW

Indoor Area

The Main Studio Area

Workout Stations: You can see the various "Workout Stations" arranged along the perimeter. The 3D view shows these as slightly raised or clearly demarcated platforms, ensuring users have personal "territory" for training.

Glazed Facade: The left and bottom edges of the diagram show large glass panels. This indicates the studio relies heavily on natural light and likely overlooks the "Outdoor Terrace" we discussed earlier.

Open Central Floor: The middle of the studio remains clear, allowing for flexible movement, group classes, or transition space between stations.

The "Fuel Bar" & Entrance

Service Core: This is the social heart of the facility. The isometric view reveals a "U-shaped" counter which functions as a juice bar or reception desk.

Transition Zone: The entrance is positioned at the top right. Users enter, pass the "Fuel Bar," and then transition into the more private workout studio.

Acoustic/Visual Partition: A partial-height wall separates the clatter of the bar area from the focused environment of the studio.

Technical Details

Structural Grid: The thin dashed lines crossing the floor represent a structural grid, likely aligning with the ceiling baffles seen in the first section image.

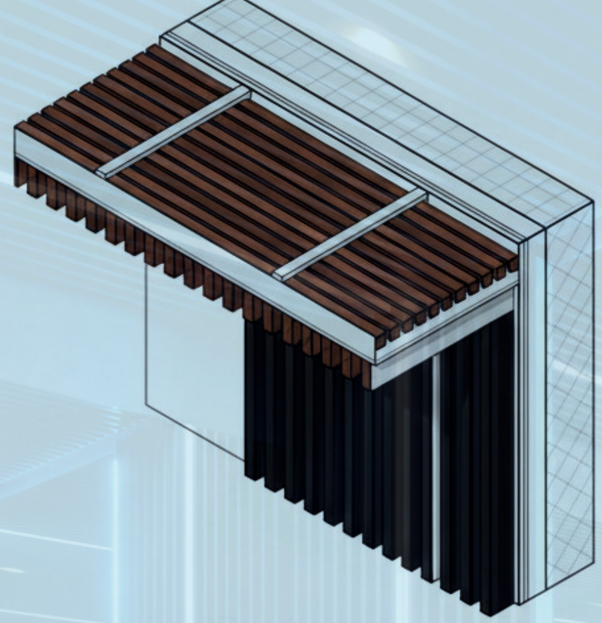
Boundary Line: The red dashed line denotes the "limit of work," showing exactly where the interior design ends and the building shell begins.

Design Insight

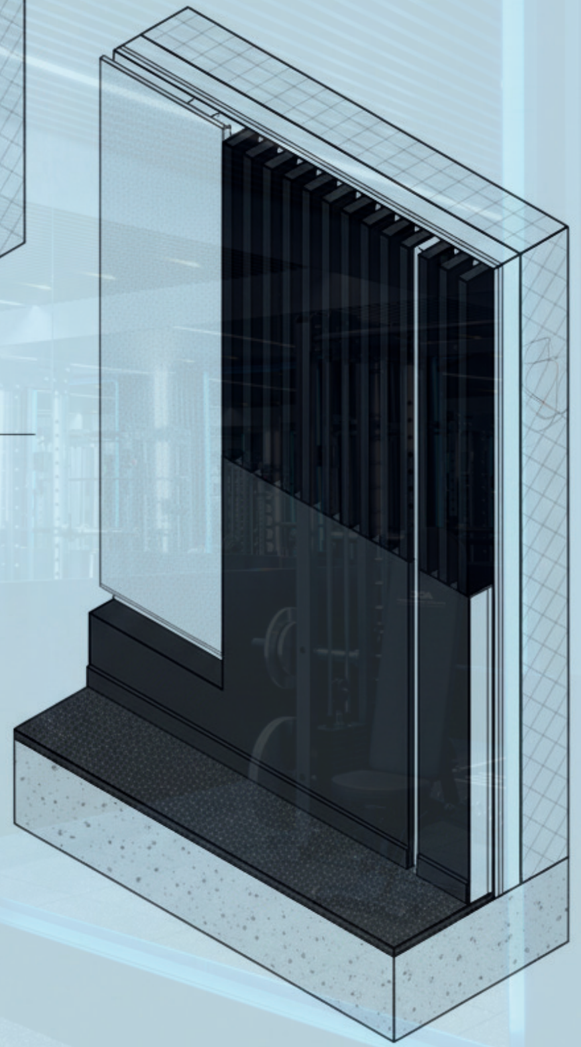
This layout follows a "Retail-to-Wellness" logic: the "Fuel Bar" acts as an inviting storefront, while the workout stations are tucked further back to provide privacy for members while they train.

SLAT ELEVATION

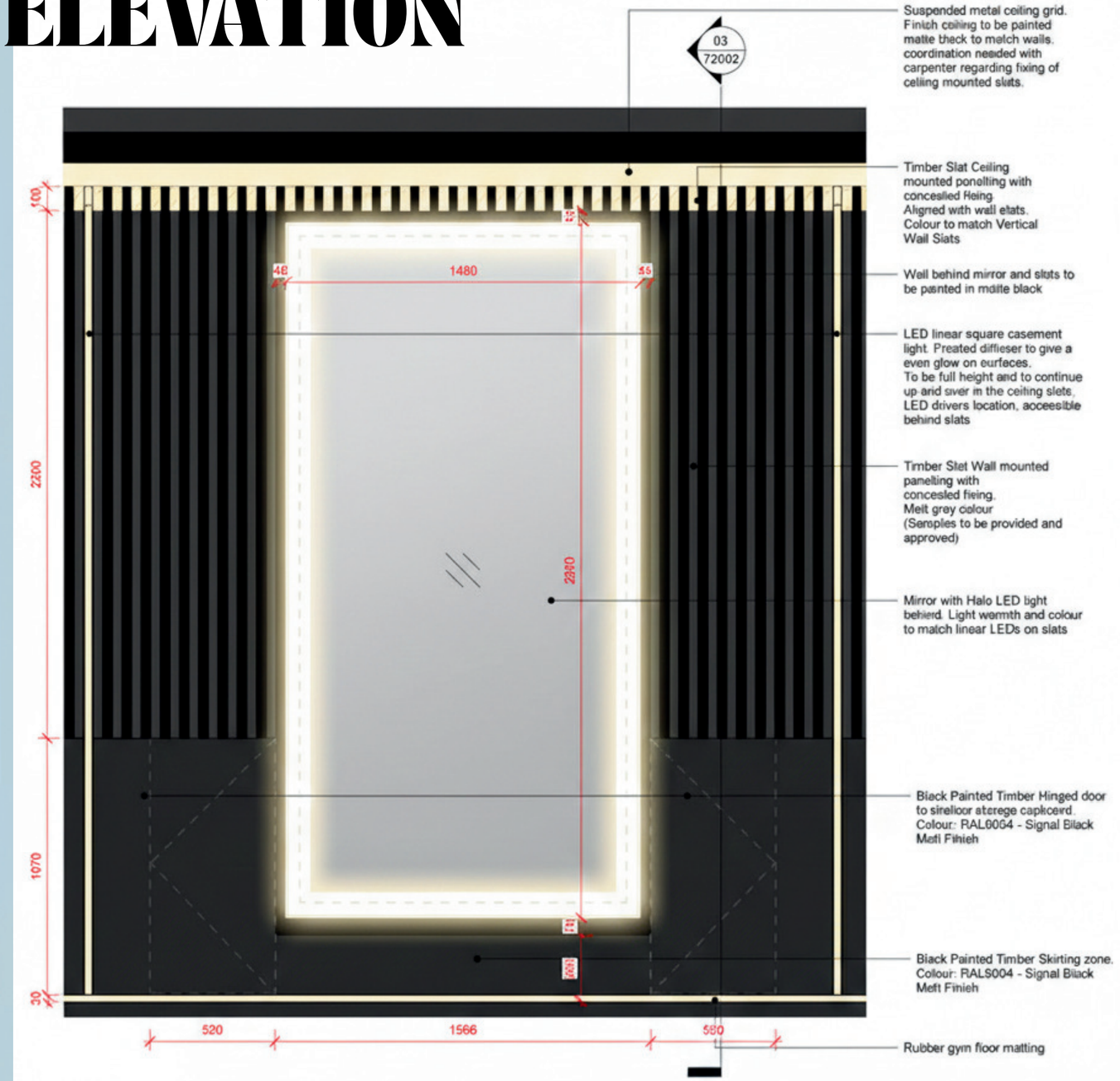
Typical Workout Zone



03 Typical Workout Area Slat Plinth Detail View_ 1



05 Typical Workout Area Slat Plinth Detail View



01 Typical Workout Zone Mirror / Slat Elevation

1 : 25

FUNCTIONS

Zone	Primary Function	Key Features
STUDIO	TRAINING	6 WORKOUT STATIONS, OPEN FLOOR SPACE
FUEL BAR	SOCIAL/NUTRITION	JUICE BAR, SEATING, RECEPTION
RETAIL	MERCHANDISING	BRANDED APPAREL, SUPPLEMENTS
RECOVERY	CLINICAL	PHYSIOTHERAPY ROOM, OFFICE
AMENITIES	HYGIENE	SHOWERS, WC, VANITY AREA

1. *The Studio & Fuel Bar (Main Hub)*

This large, open-plan area serves as the primary zone for activity and social interaction.

Workout Stations (01–06): Six dedicated zones distributed around the studio perimeter for structured training or individual exercise.

The Fuel Bar: Centrally located near the entrance, this area features a "U-shaped" juice bar designed for post-workout nutrition and social gathering.

Retail & Merchandising: As shown in the interior view, the walls are utilized for displaying ADC-branded apparel (hoodies, t-shirts, caps) and nutritional supplements (protein jars), integrating a retail experience directly into the social hub.

Aesthetic Features: The space incorporates biophilic design with hanging greenery and prominent branding ("ADC") to create a modern, lifestyle-focused atmosphere.

2. *Recovery & Support Wing*

Connected to the main studio, this secondary wing focuses on clinical recovery and personal hygiene.

Physiotherapy Room: A private space located at the far end of the wing, dedicated to physical therapy, assessments, or specialized treatment.

Office: A dedicated administrative or consultation space for staff to manage facility operations or conduct private client meetings.

Hygiene Facilities: This wing contains comprehensive facilities including:

Multiple WC (Water Closet) units.

Shower/Changing rooms for privacy.

A large Vanity Area for grooming and post-workout preparation.

Storage: Centralized storage for gym equipment, linens, or supplies.

FUNCTIONS

Indoor Area

Design & Aesthetic

The facility utilizes a dark, industrial aesthetic characterized by slatted wall panels and concrete textures. This is contrasted by vibrant, zone-specific neon lighting in blue, magenta, and amber. To soften the atmosphere, biophilic elements such as hanging greenery are integrated into the social and recovery zones.

Brand Identity

Branding for the Athletic Development Club (ADC) is woven into the architecture through custom-branded equipment, neon signage, and dedicated retail displays for club apparel.

FUNCTIONS

Outdoor Area

Training & Social Zones:

Features a large Main Workout Studio with six specialized stations, a HIIT/Flex Space for group classes, and a Fuel Bar social area.

Wellness & Amenities:

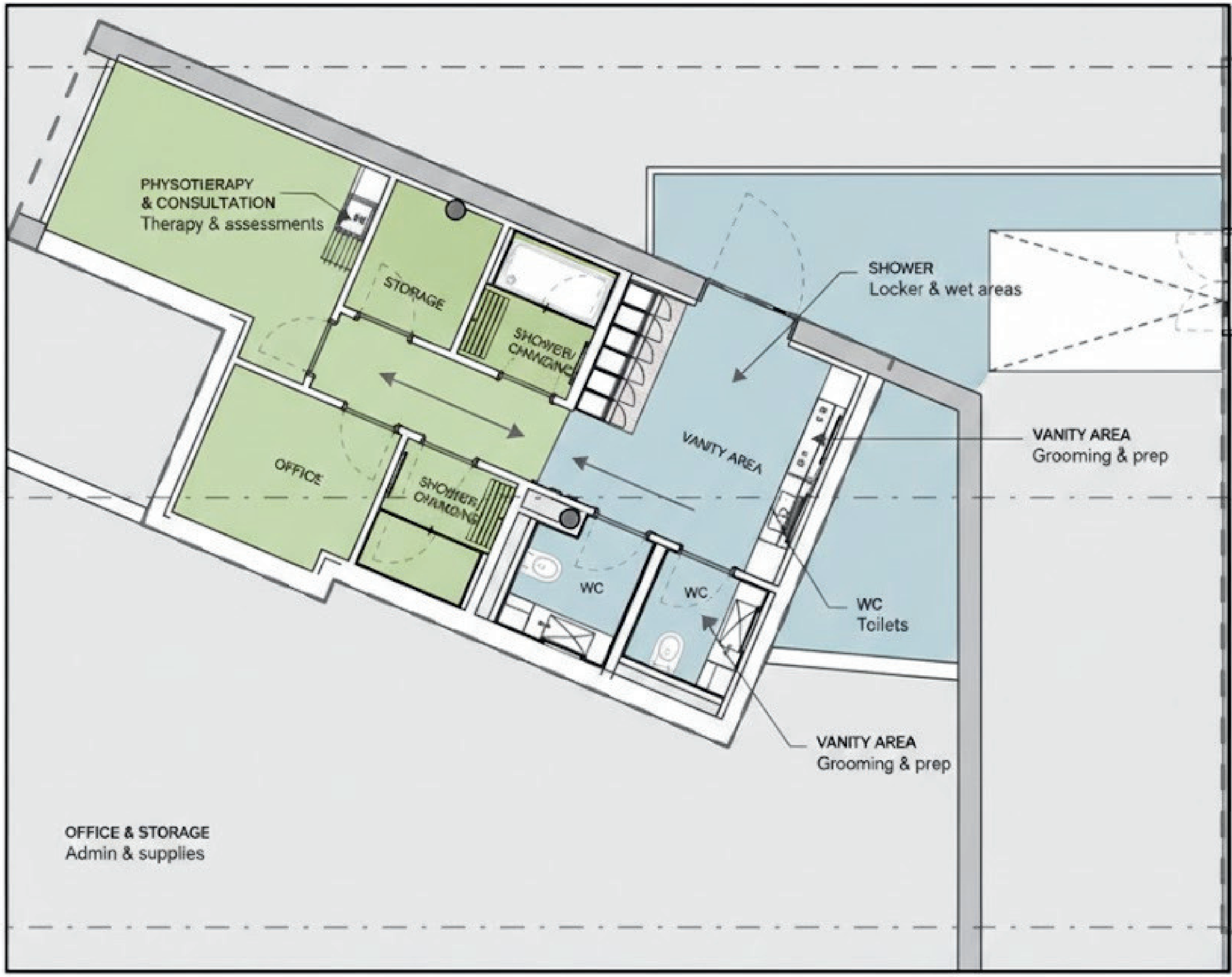
Houses a Physiotherapy & Consultation suite and dedicated changing facilities with specialized Vanity Areas and showers.

Aesthetic:

Defined by a "Dark Industrial" palette of concrete and black slatted panels, electrified by magenta, cyan, and amber neon accents.

Signature Details:

Integration of biophilic greenery and high-end marble textures alongside custom-branded ADC equipment.



MATERIAL & FINISH SELECTION

wood

Matte Black Metal Framing

Metal ceiling

Rubber Flooring

Material selection plays a significant role in balancing energy and comfort within the space.
For the training zone, They selected exposed concrete finishes and rubber flooring to emphasize durability and performance.
Matte black metal framing enhances the industrial aesthetic.
In contrast, the coffee area incorporates warmer wood textures and softer finishes to create a welcoming atmosphere. This material transition subtly differentiates the zones while maintaining visual harmony.
The retail shelving uses metal and wood combinations to align with both athletic strength and café warmth.
The overall palette is neutral with strong contrasts, allowing branding elements to stand out.

MATERIAL TEXTURE ANALYSIS

Rough & High-Durability Textures

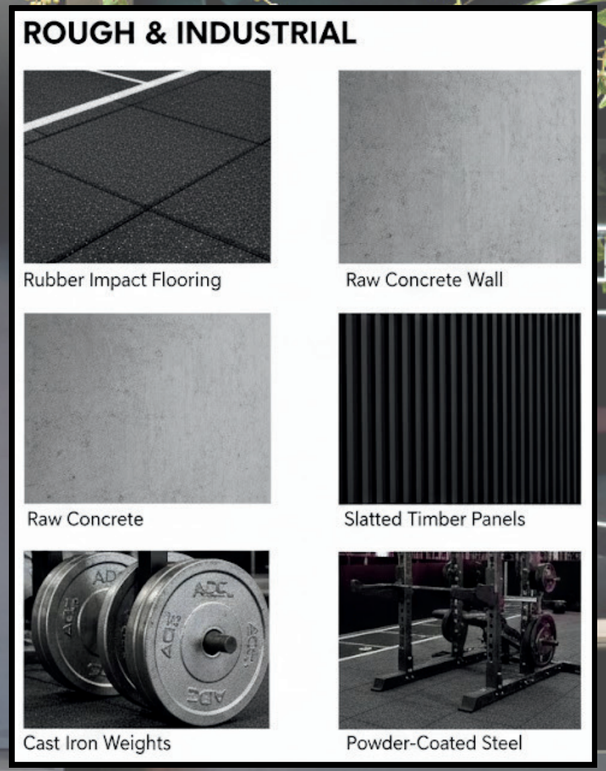
Designed for high-impact performance and an industrial edge.

Impact Flooring: Heavy-duty, granular rubber tiling in the Main Studio for shock absorption and grip.

Exposed Concrete: Raw, grey cement-textured walls in the shower and vanity areas providing a brutalist, urban feel.

Slatted Wall Panels: Vertical black timber or composite slats that create a rhythmic, ribbed texture across the walls and ceilings.

Cast Iron & Steel: Rough-textured, powder-coated finishes on the ADC-branded weight plates and power racks.



Soft & Refined Textures

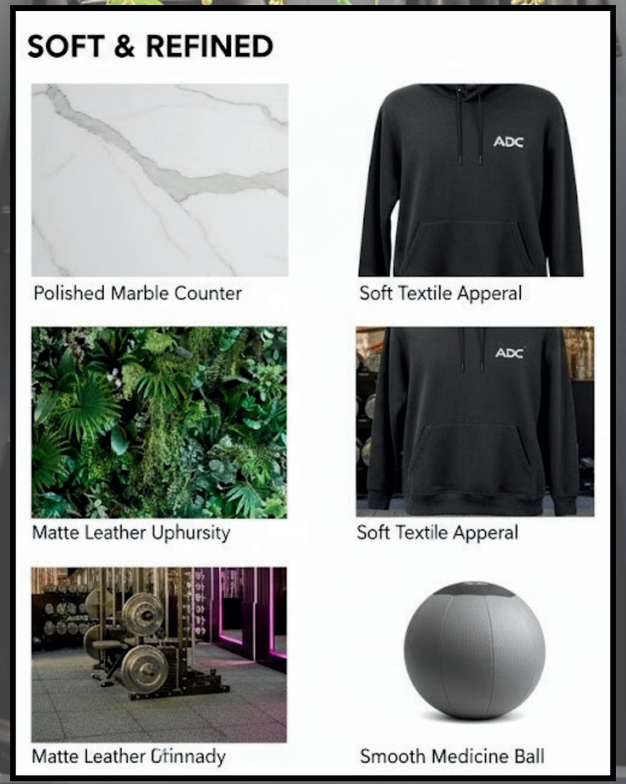
Integrated to provide comfort, visual warmth, and a sense of luxury.

Marble-Look Surfaces: Polished, smooth-to-the-touch countertops with light veining found in the Fuel Bar and vanity zones.

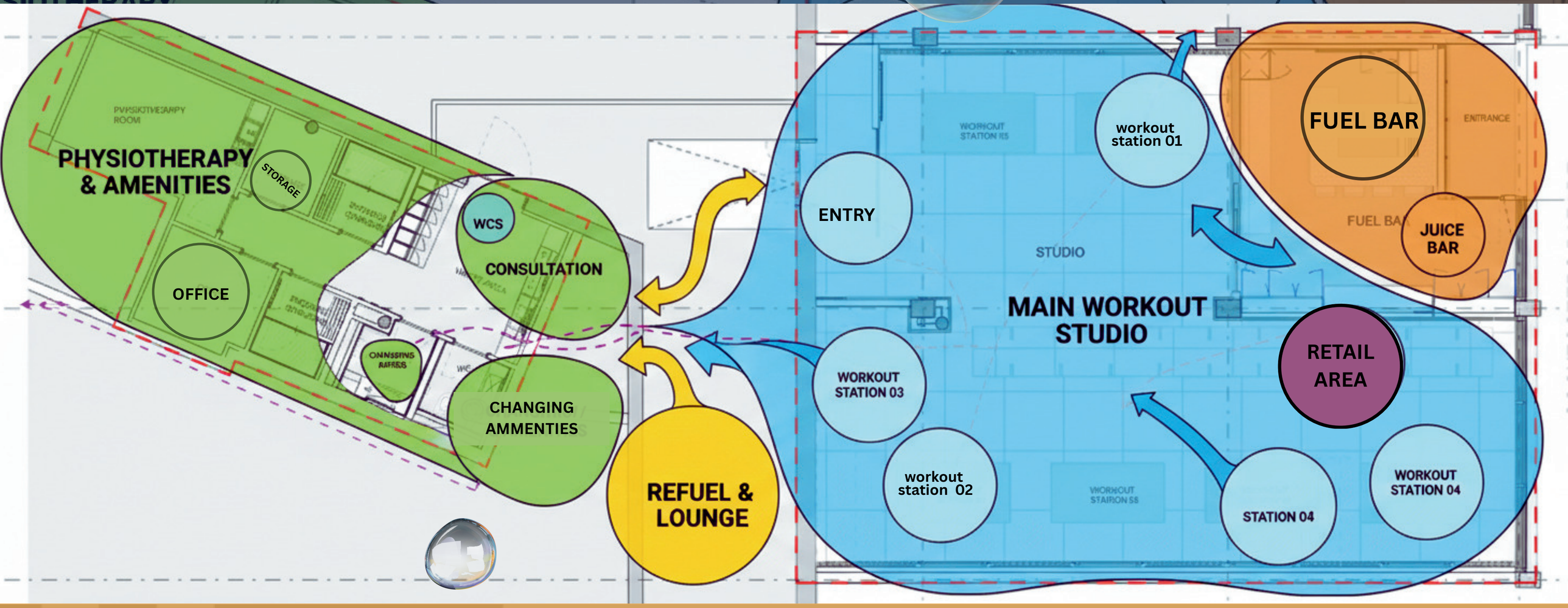
Biophilic Greenery: Soft, organic textures from hanging vines and preserved moss walls that contrast against the rigid architecture.

Leather Upholstery: Matte black, smooth leather or high-quality vinyl used for the seating at the Fuel Bar and on workout benches.

Textile Apparel: Soft cotton and fleece fabrics featured in the retail display area for ADC club merchandise.



BUBBLE DIAGRAM

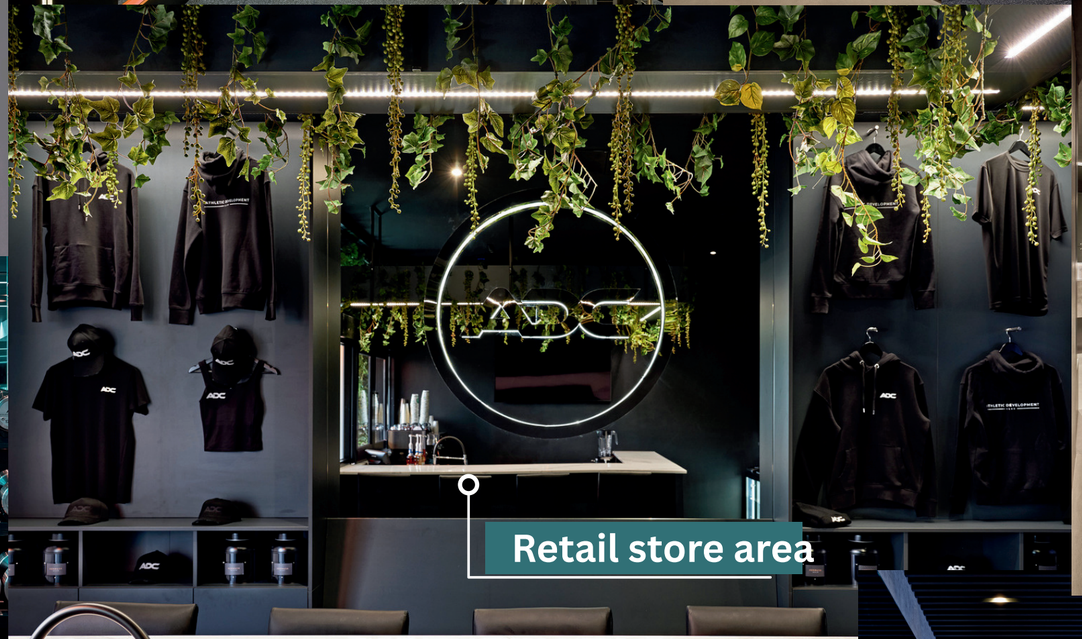


MOODBOARD

Locker Room

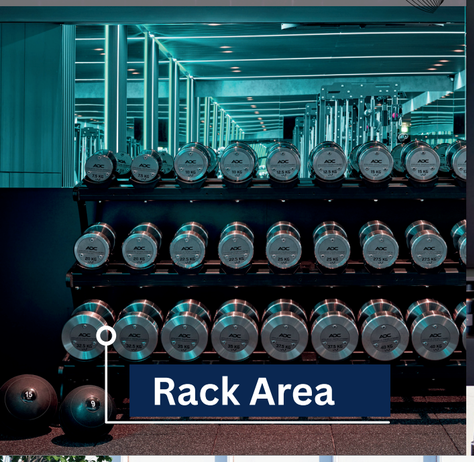
Working Studio

Cafe Area



Retail store area

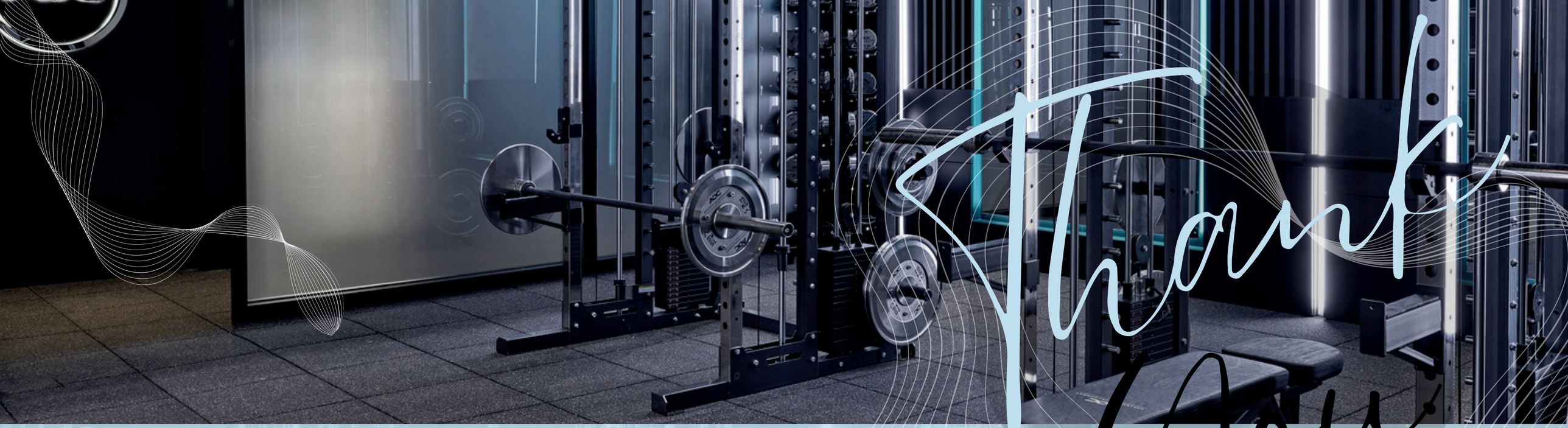
Changing room



Rack Area

Outdoor Area

Gym studio area



Thank You

SO THAT’S OUR SPACE — WHERE GRIND MEETS DESIGN, PRIVACY MEETS PRESENCE, AND EVERY REP FEELS LIKE ARCHITECTURE IN MOTION.”

By: Priyanshi Mathur